



Ventilator Weaning at Home — Family Handbook

Gradual, Safe Transition From Machine to Independent Breathing | Jupiter Homecare Chennai

Weaning off a ventilator after critical illness is a delicate process. With the right team and monitoring, it can be done **safely and comfortably at home**.

✓ 1. What Ventilator Weaning Means

Gradual reduction of machine support as the lungs and muscles regain strength. Involves **careful adjustments by ICU-trained nurses** under intensivist guidance.

✓ 2. Why Home Is Better

- Reduced stress → faster breathing recovery.
- Lower infection risk vs prolonged hospital ICU.
- Family support improves emotional resilience.
- Significant cost savings.

✓ 3. Family Role

- Encourage **deep breathing & coughing exercises** as advised.
- Help with proper positioning (semi-upright, lateral).
- Avoid sudden removal or tube movement.
- Observe patient comfort and energy.

✓ 4. Red Flags — Call Your Care Team

- Sudden breathlessness or labored breathing.
- High fever, discolored secretions.
- Drop in oxygen saturation or BP alarms.
- Chest pain or extreme fatigue.

✓ 5. Our Approach

- 24/7 ICU nurses + **tele-ICU oversight**.
- Specialist-guided ventilator setting changes.
- Emergency escalation & ambulance backup if needed.